

Self-study

Table of contents

1 Python as a calculator	1
2 Functions & arrays	4
3 Parentheses	10
4 Working with datasets	11

```
try:
    import fysisk_biokemi
    print("Already installed")
except ImportError:
    %pip install -q "fysisk_biokemi[colab] @ git+https://github.com/au-mbg/fysisk-biokemi.git#subdirectory=course-utils"
```

```
import numpy as np
```

1 Python as a calculator

We can use Jupyter notebooks as a calculator with all the operations we are familiar with from a regular calculator.

```
1 + 1      # Addition with +
3 - 1      # Subtraction with -
4 * 4      # Multiplication with *
20 / 5     # Division with /
```

(a) Doing some calculations

Use Jupyter notebook to calculate the following:

1. $21 + 21$
2. $53 - 11$
3. 6×7
4. $\frac{546}{13}$

```
# Write your code in this cell
```

(b) Using variables

As also mentioned in “Introduction to the molecules of life”, it is often helpful to define quantities in variables, which gives them a name that can be used later. A variable is defined by using `=`, for example, we can define

```
a = 21 + 21
```

This means that the result of the calculation is stored in a.

Repeat the calculations from exercise 1, but now save each result in a variable

```
a = 21 + 21
b = ... # Replace ... with your code
# Create variables c and d.
```

We can then use the defined variables in a new calculation

```
total = (a + b + c + d) / 4
print(total)
```

```
42.0
```

(c) A biological calculation

In “Introduction to the molecules of life” we have made calculations about the number of cells in different parts of the body.

```
total_cells = 37_000_000_000_000
brain_cells = 86_000_000_000
liver_cells = 240_000_000_000
skin_cells = 1_600_000_000_000
```

Use Jupyter as a calculator to calculate the percentage each category represents of the total number of cells in the body, i.e., for each category calculate

$$P = \frac{\text{Number}}{\text{Total}} \times 100$$

```
brain_pct = ... # Replace ... with your code.
liver_pct = ... # Replace ... with your code.
# Calculate and create variable for skin_pct
```

```
print(brain_pct)
print(liver_pct)
print(skin_pct)
```

```
0.23243243243243245
0.6486486486486486
4.324324324324325
```

(d) Using functions

i Note

When we perform the same calculation multiple times, it's smart not to have to write the same code again, it makes the code more readable and reduces the chance of making errors. The way to avoid this is by using **functions**, a function in Python defines a recipe that is executed when it is called.

Above, we have for example used the function `print` to write output. A function is defined like this

```
def my_function(a, b):  
    result = a * b  
    return result
```

It's important that the function is indented (pushed to the right) as Python needs this to read it. When a function is defined as above, the calculation is not performed, just like writing down a recipe doesn't make a meal, only when the function is "called" is it executed

```
my_function(6, 7) # Would give 6*7 = 42
```

```
42
```

Complete the function below so it calculates the percentage of value out of total.

```
def percentage(value, total):  
    result = ... # Replace ... with your code.  
    return result
```

We can then use the function to calculate the percentages

```
brain_pct = percentage(brain_cells, total_cells)  
liver_pct = percentage(liver_cells, total_cells)  
skin_pct = percentage(skin_cells, total_cells)  
print(brain_pct, liver_pct, skin_pct)
```

```
0.23243243243243245 0.6486486486486486 4.324324324324325
```

(f) Special functions

i Note

We have now seen that we can use Jupyter notebooks as a calculator to make calculations with the basic arithmetic operations. However, we often need to calculate power functions, square roots, exponential functions or logarithms.

Fortunately, this is also easy with Python, as we can use a package that implements these operations as functions - specifically `numpy`.

Power functions, i.e., x^k can be calculated as

- `x**k`

The other three can be calculated with NumPy as

- `np.sqrt`
- `np.exp`
- `np.log`

Use numpy functions to calculate the following

- 6.4807^2
- $\sqrt{1764}$
- $e^{3.737669}$
- $\log(66.6863)$

```
import numpy as np # This imports NumPy so we can use the functions.

result_1 = ... # Your code here
result_2 = ... # Your code here
result_3 = ... # Your code here
result_4 = ... # Your code here

print(result_1, result_2, result_3, result_4)
```

```
import numpy as np
```

2 Functions & arrays

Previously we looked at functions, we will build on that now. Remember that a function is a recipe that describes how a calculation should be performed that can be reused many times.

A function is defined with `def` followed by its name and its parameters (also called arguments) are placed in the parentheses.

```
def my_function(a, b):
    result = a * b
    return result
```

The function is only executed when it is called, in this case for example

```
my_result = my_function(6, 7)
print(my_result)
```

42

Where we now have the output of the function in the variable `my_result`.

(a) Calculating cell sizes

The tables below show the radius of different cell types

Cell type	Radius
Mycoplasma	~0.2–0.3 μm
Typical bacterium	~1–2 μm
Yeast cell (<i>S. cerevisiae</i>)	~5–7 μm
Red blood cells (human)	~7–8 μm
Lymphocyte (white blood cell)	~8–10 μm
Typical animal cell	~10–20 μm
Typical plant cell	~20–100 μm
Human egg cell (oocyte)	~120–140 μm
Neuron (cell body)	~10–100 μm

We have previously calculated the volume of the cells by assuming that they are spherical, whereby the volume is given by

$$V(r) = \frac{4}{3}\pi r^3$$

Write a function that takes radius `r` as an argument and calculates volume - you can use `np.pi` instead of writing π yourself!

```
def ... # Replace with your code
    ... # Replace with your code
```

Call the function with some of the different radii from the table

```
mycoplasma_volume = ... # Replace with your code
print(mycoplasma_volume)
# Do the same for some of the other cell types
...
```

(b) Calculations with arrays.

i Note

We have previously seen some of the different data types in Python

- Integers `int`
- Floats `float`
- Strings `str`

But there are many other types that can be helpful in different contexts. One such type is numpy arrays, an example of a numpy array is shown below

```
A = np.array([1.0, 2.5, 3.5])
```

One of the smart things about arrays is that we can perform operations on all the content at once

```
B = 2 * A  
print(B)
```

```
[2.  5.  7.]
```

The same is true for using the array A in a function, for example we can write

```
def example_function(array):  
    return 1 + array  
  
print(example_function(A))
```

```
[2.  3.5  4.5]
```

Create an array that contains the specified cell radii and use your volume function to calculate the volume of all cells at once

```
radii = np.array([...]) # Replace ... with your code
```

```
cell_volumes = ... # Replace ... with your code.  
print(cell_volumes)
```

(c) Array operations

i Note

There are many other operations we can perform on arrays, such as finding the largest or smallest number
We can find the cell type with the largest volume as

```
np.max(cell_volumes)
```

```
np.float64(9202772.0799157)
```

The corresponding function for finding the smallest number is called `np.min`.

The cell below creates an array with 1000 numbers

```
array_with_numbers = np.random.rand(1000) * np.exp(3.737669)
```

Use `np.max` to find the largest number in `array_with_numbers`

```
largest_number = ... # Replace ... with your code  
print(largest_number)
```

(d) Array indexing

i Note

Sometimes we are interested in specific entries in an array, so we also need to be able to extract data from an array. This is “indexing”, for example if we have an array

```
my_array = np.array([0, 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12, 14, 16, 18, 20])
```

We can extract the fourth number like this

```
fourth_number = my_array[3]
```

In Python we start counting from 0, so the fourth number is found at position 3.

Use indexing to calculate the sum of

- The last number (Position 10)
- The second number (Position 1)
- The fourth number (Position ??)
- The eighth number (Position ??)

```
sum_of_numbers = ... # Replace with your code  
print(sum_of_numbers)
```

(f) Working with data

In molecular biology we often work with spectra, where the axes are for example

- x : Wavelength measured in nm
- y : Absorption coefficient

```
from fysisk_biokemi import load_dataset

df = load_dataset("chlorophyll")
print(df)

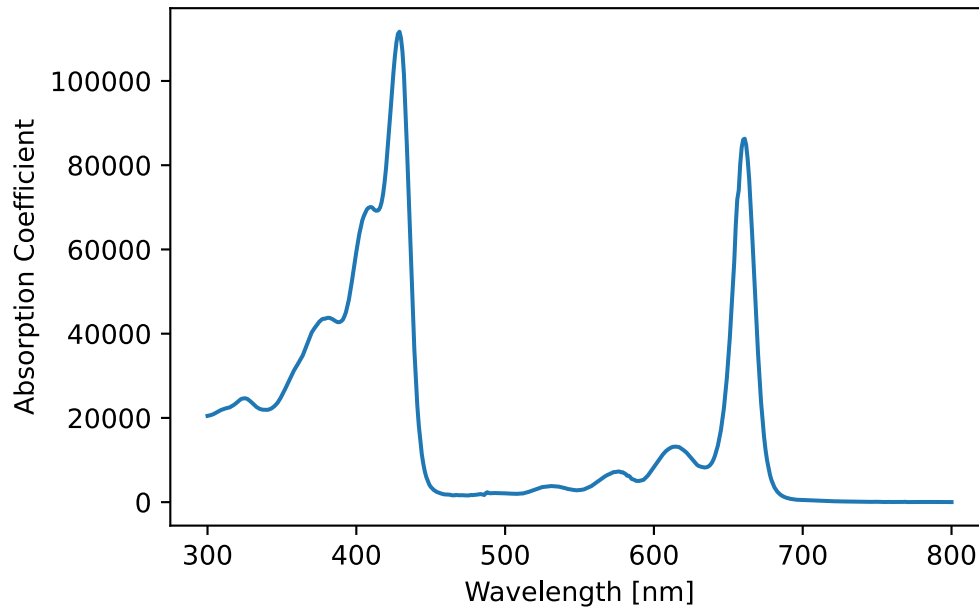
wavelengths = df['Wavelength(nm)'] # An array with 501 entries
absorption = df['AdsorptionCoefficient'] # An array with 501 entries
```

	Wavelength(nm)	AdsorptionCoefficient
0	300	20487.000
1	301	20547.000
2	302	20642.000
3	303	20767.000
4	304	20899.000
..	...	...
496	796	26.665
497	797	15.556
498	798	29.164
499	799	21.473
500	800	18.396

[501 rows x 2 columns]

```
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
fig, ax = plt.subplots()
ax.plot(wavelengths, absorption)
ax.set_xlabel('Wavelength [nm]')
ax.set_ylabel('Absorption Coefficient')
```

```
Text(0, 0.5, 'Absorption Coefficient')
```

Caution

How the plotting works will be explained in another exercise, for now just appreciate the pretty plot.

We want to use NumPy to find what the maximum absorption coefficient is, and at which wavelength it occurs. Start by finding the maximum absorption coefficient using `np.max`

```
max_absorption = ... # Replace ... with your code
print(max_absorption)
```

We can use another function from NumPy to find the wavelength where the absorption coefficient has its maximum

```
index_max_abs = np.argmax(absorption)
```

Note

`np.argmax` finds the index of the **argument** that contains the **max** value.

Now use `index_max_abs` to extract the corresponding wavelength from `wavelengths`

```
wavelength_max_abs = ... # Your code here
```

```
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
fig, ax = plt.subplots()
ax.plot(wavelengths, absorption)
```

```
ax.axvline(wavelength_max_abs, color='red')
ax.set_xlabel('Wavelength [nm]')
ax.set_ylabel('Absorption Coefficient')
plt.show()
```

3 Parentheses

Later in the course we will see equations such as the quadratic binding equation

$$\theta = \frac{K_D + [P_{tot}] + [L_{tot}]}{2[P_{tot}]} - \sqrt{\left(\frac{K_D + [P_{tot}] + [L_{tot}]}{2[P_{tot}]}\right)^2 - \frac{[L_{tot}]}{[P_{tot}]}}$$

which can be used to describe titration data that reports protein saturation as a function of total ligand concentration.

Calculating this function requires that we are careful with parentheses! Which we have all learned, but since it is very important in this context, it is worth refreshing.

(a) Mind the (...)

For the following pairs of expressions, calculate both (by hand or mentally, according to preference.)

- $2 + 3 \times 4$ vs. $(2 + 3) \times 4$
- $10 - 2^2$ vs. $(10 - 2)^2$
- $100/10 \times 2$ vs. $100/(10 \times 2)$
- $\frac{12+8}{4}$ vs. $12 + 8/4$

(b) Beware of the (...)

For the three calculations below, consider what the result is **before** you run the cell.

```
a = 1 + 2 * 3 ** 2
```

```
b = (1 + 2) * 3 ** 2
```

```
c = 1 + 2 * (3 ** 2)
```

The cell below prints the result for each calculation

```
print(f'{a = }')
print(f'{b = }')
print(f'{c = }')
```

(c) Fix the (...)

We want to calculate the expression

$$\frac{a + b}{c + d}$$

Someone has implemented the function below, but it is incorrect - your task is to fix it.

```
def function(a, b, c, d):  
    return a + b / c + d  
  
result_1 = function(152, 16, 2, 2)  
print(result_1)
```

(d) Implement the (...)

The first term of the quadratic binding equation is

$$\frac{K_D + [P_{tot}] + [L_{tot}]}{2[P_{tot}]} = \frac{a + b + c}{2b}$$

Complete the function below so it calculates this expression

```
def first_term(a, b, c):  
    return ... # Replace ... with your code.  
  
result = first_term(100, 2, 66)  
print(result)
```

4 Working with datasets

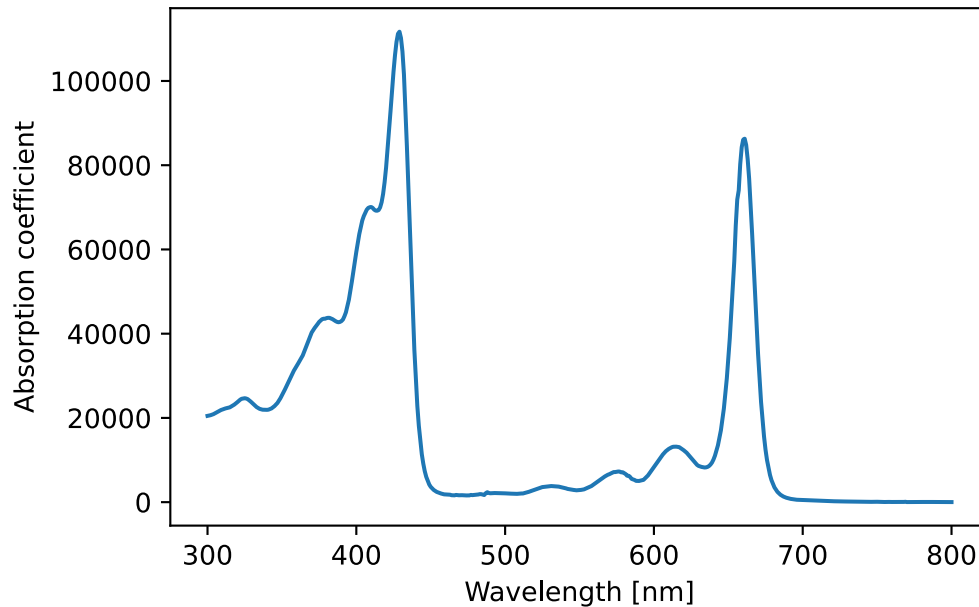
```
import numpy as np  
import pandas as pd  
from fysisk_biokemi import load_dataset, get_dataset_path  
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
```

We have previously looked at a dataset about the absorption spectrum of chlorophyll, but we weren't focused on how we handled this dataset.

What we achieved was plotting the dataset, as seen below

```
chloro_df = load_dataset("chlorophyll")  
wavelengths = chloro_df['Wavelength(nm)'] # An array with 501 entries  
absorption = chloro_df['AdsorptionCoefficient'] # An array with 501 entries  
  
fig, ax = plt.subplots()  
ax.plot(wavelengths, absorption)  
ax.set_xlabel('Wavelength [nm]')  
ax.set_ylabel('Absorption coefficient')
```

```
Text(0, 0.5, 'Absorption coefficient')
```



This time we will investigate a bit more how we can work with a dataset.

NumPy arrays as datasets.

It is important that we keep good track of our data, it is often smart to use a data type that helps us with this. We have previously seen arrays, which is one possibility - e.g.

```
a = np.array([1, 2, 3, 4])
b = np.array([1, 4, 9, 16])
```

But if we have many quantities it can quickly become unmanageable - another possibility is to store all our quantities in the same array

```
combined_array = np.array([[1, 2, 3, 4], [1, 4, 9, 16]])
print(combined_array[0, :]) # Corresponds to a
print(combined_array[1, :]) # Corresponds to b
```

```
[1 2 3 4]
[ 1  4  9 16]
```

i Note

NumPy arrays can have multiple dimensions, `combined_array` here has two dimensions (like a matrix). In this case each row describes one of our quantities. Here `:` is used to mean “all” in indexing so `[0, :]` can be read as first row all columns.

But then we need to keep track of which axis contains which quantity. Sometimes it can be fine to keep our data as `np.array` but other times it's better in other ways.

Pandas DataFrame

One such other way to handle a dataset is by using a new type, namely a pandas DataFrame.

We can create a DataFrame from our two arrays like this;

```
df = pd.DataFrame({"a": a, "b": b})
df.style.hide() # This just make printing a bit simpler
print(df)
```

	a	b
0	1	1
1	2	4
2	3	9
3	4	16

Here we have three columns, the first is index, the second is a and the third is b.

Note

The chlorophyll dataset was actually also a DataFrame.

With a DataFrame we have more possibilities for indexing, we can for example use the name of the column.

```
print(df['a'])
```

0	1
1	2
2	3
3	4

Name: a, dtype: int64

(a) Calculations with a dataset

Calculate the formula $2 \times a$ where a comes from the dataset above df

```
result = ... # Replace ... with your code.
print(result)
```

(b) Elementwise operations

We can also add two arrays together using whats called an *elementwise* operation where for example the first element of each array are added, the second elements are added and so on.

Use this to calculate $c = a + b$.

```
c = ... # Replace ... with your code
print(c)
```

(c) Plotting a dataset

Make a plot of a versus b where the two quantities come from the DataFrame `df`.

```
fig, ax = plt.subplots()
... # Write your code to plot.
```

Tip

You need to extract the two columns `df['a']` and `df['b']` and put those in `ax.plot(..., ...)`.

(d) Datasets from files

Note

Often we don't want to write our dataset directly into code, but store them as separate files that could for example come from experimental equipment.

We can get data from an Excel file, like this

```
#| eval: false
dataset_path = "/path/to/the/file/that/has/our/data.xlsx"
df = pd.read_excel(dataset_path)
```

Through out the course we will use a widget to load datasets from your computer, this makes it a little easier to manage with Google Colab.

You can run the cell below and click on the “Upload”-button that appears and you use that to select the `reverse_reaction.xlsx` dataset that you can download from here [datasets](#) under the “Additional Datasets” tab at the bottom of the page.

You should save it somewhere where you can find it again - a good idea would be to put it in a folder specifically for this course.

```
from fysisk_biokemi.widgets import DataUploader
from IPython.display import display
uploader = DataUploader()
uploader.display()
```

Once you've uploaded the dataset you can run the next cell

```
df = uploader.get_dataframe()
display(df)
```

Based on the information that has been printed out what do you think the dataset contains? Think about the following

- How many columns are there?

- What is the title of each column?
- How many rows are there?

(f) Plot the dataset

Now that we have retrieved the dataset we want to investigate it more easily by plotting it.

Complete the code below

```
fig, ax = plt.subplots()
ax.plot(df['time'], ..., label='[A]') # Replace ... with your code
... # Replace ... with your code that plots time versus concentration_B
ax.set_ylabel('Concentration') # Sets name on y-axis
ax.set_xlabel('Time') # Sets name on x-axis
ax.legend() # Shows what 'label' each plotted curve has.
```

What do you think the dataset shows?

(g) Calculation with dataset

As mentioned we can also do calculations with a dataset. Calculate

$$[T] = [A] + [B]$$

And complete the plot in the cell below

```
concentration_T = ... # Replace ... with your code

fig, ax = plt.subplots()
ax.plot(..., ..., label='[T]', color='C2') # Replace both ... with your code.

# From before
ax.plot(df['time'], df['concentration_A'], label='[A]')
ax.plot(df['time'], df['concentration_B'], label='[B]')
ax.set_ylabel('Concentration') # Sets name on y-axis
ax.set_xlabel('Time') # Sets name on x-axis
ax.legend() # Shows what 'label' each plotted curve has.
```

Why do you think it looks like it does?